

Focus

What I care about is concentration of power, and its most measurable form is policy capture: concentrated private interests quietly bending public decisions away from the public good. I want to build the infrastructure that makes capture visible and to translate technical evidence into terms policymakers can act on, with AI governance as the most urgent live case (a well-funded industry on one side, a diffuse public that polls 73% for regulation on the other). I work best at the seam between technical work and policy, and I'm based in Washington, DC.

Target roles

Technical-to-policy translation; AI governance research; building measurement and accountability tooling for democratic oversight.

Experience

- **“LobbyView for all 50 states”** (github.com/danparshall/lobby_analysis): designed and shipped open-source infrastructure that extracts state lobbying-disclosure data from portals and statutes and reconstructs principal → lobbyist → lawmaker → bill influence chains. Three live state releases (WI, NY, OH); New York alone reconciles \$153M in bill-linked lobbying compensation exactly to the source filings.
 - *Statute-reading layer*: a harness that reads each state’s lobbying statutes and scores them against a 181-row, cell-typed schema drawn from nine published rubrics, using parallel Claude + GPT-5.2 extraction with per-cell citations at roughly \$3 per state.
- **“Measuring AI’s Economic Reach”** (canaryinstitute.ai/research): co-authored the CDR (Cognitive, Deployment, Regulatory) framework over 23,850 task-activity pairs and 923 occupations, finding that 50.5% of U.S. economy-weighted labor time is already within current AI’s reach.
- **Founded the Canary Institute**, an independent, non-partisan AI-policy nonprofit. Cold-walked roughly fifty Congressional offices with fact sheets and leave-behinds; I offer technical briefings as an interlocutor with nothing to sell.
- **AI alignment research**: authored “Navigator Identity as a Mechanism for AI Corrigibility,” proposing Bilateral Constitutional AI (BCAI), which reframes alignment as navigating competing values rather than installing a fixed one.
- **15+ years building with data at scale**: principal/senior data science at Lakeside, Hobsons/PowerSchool, and MITRE/FAA (production ML, differential privacy, GAN synthetic data, causal-inference impact analysis at petabyte scale); before that a physics PhD and a NIST instrument-scientist post on multi-terabyte neutron data.

Engagement with Democracy

- **CORDA Democracy Fellow, Spring 2026.**
 - *Owned*: the per-state extraction product (WI, NY, and OH influence-chain releases) and the statute-reading reference layer underneath it.
 - *Learned*: two of the most-cited lobbying-disclosure rubrics correlate at only $r=0.04$, so instead of picking a “correct” rubric I built a rubric-neutral substrate anyone can re-aggregate.
- **Ongoing**: the Canary Institute (public-interest AI-policy research, public translation, and Congressional outreach), with writing at canaryinstitute.ai/blog.